PROactive PRONUNCIATION

“AA” /æ/ Vs. “EH” /ɛ/ Minimal Pairs

Practice the comparisons below of /æ/ versus /ɛ/ to hear and feel the pronunciation difference. “AA” requires an open jaw and spread open lip smile.

“EH”	**“AA”**		
any	Annie	letter	latter
bed	bad	m	am
beg	bag	men	man
bet	bat	mess	mass
blessed	blast	met	mat
bread	Brad	n	Ann
dead	dad	net	gnat
den	Dan	peck	pack
dense	dance	pen	pan
Ed	add	pet	pat
effect	affect	pest	past
ex	axe	rent	rant
fester	faster	said	sad
flex	flax	send	sand
gem	jam	set	sat
head	had	slept	slapped
hem	ham	speckle	spackle
Ken	can	Steph	staff
kept	capped	tech	tack
kettle	cattle	ten	tan
left	laughed	trek	track
leg	lag	wreck	rack